

KONA VENKATA SAI LAKSHMI

Senior Software Engineer — Backend Systems & Cloud Data Platforms

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SUMMARY

Senior Software Engineer with 5+ years designing, scaling, and owning distributed backend systems and cloud data platforms at enterprise scale. Architected and delivered a config-driven data platform on Databricks processing 60+ tables through 12 automated pipelines, and re-engineered core services with Redis caching to cut latency 87% (800ms to 100ms). Drives architecture and design decisions as technical lead across caching strategy, event-driven systems, and service decoupling; led legacy-to-microservices modernization now serving 10+ downstream systems at 99.9% uptime. Deep expertise in Java/Spring Boot, Apache Kafka, distributed systems, and Microsoft Azure.

SKILLS

System Design & Architecture: Distributed Systems, Event-Driven Architecture, API Gateway, Circuit Breaker, Rate Limiting, Fault Tolerance

Languages & Backend: Java 8/11/17, Python, SQL, Spring Boot, Spring MVC, REST APIs, Microservices, Hibernate, OAuth2/OIDC

Data Engineering: Databricks, Delta Live Tables, PySpark, Delta Lake, Unity Catalog, Auto Loader, Medallion Architecture, Databricks Asset Bundles

Messaging & CDC: Apache Kafka, Oracle GoldenGate (CDC), IBM MQ, Internal Enterprise Messaging Bus, Confluent Cloud, Dead Letter Queues

Cloud, Caching & Security: Microsoft Azure, Docker, CI/CD (GitHub Actions), Redis (Cache Invalidation, TTL), Oracle, MongoDB, Microsoft Entra ID, Credential Rotation, Vulnerability Remediation

Legacy & Enterprise Platforms: CORBA, Apache Struts, WebLogic, Tomcat, Legacy-to-Microservices Modernization

Practices: Agile/Scrum, System Design Reviews, Code Reviews, Test-Driven Development, Performance Optimization, Monitoring & Alerting

EXPERIENCE

Software Engineer | AT&T

Sep 2025 – Present

- Built AT&T's Enterprise Data Framework from the ground up on Databricks — a config-driven ingestion platform processing 60+ tables across 8 schemas from Kafka, SFTP, and REST API sources through 12 serverless Delta Live Tables pipelines.
- Invented a reusable YAML-driven configuration registry pattern (adopted company-wide as the standard template) that cut new data-source onboarding from days to hours with zero code changes.
- Built an orchestration agent for cross-service knowledge base retrieval on Databricks, automating knowledge lookup across distributed services and reducing manual research effort for engineering teams.
- Architected fault-tolerant, event-driven systems using Apache Kafka, IBM MQ, and the internal enterprise messaging bus — implemented retry policies, dead letter queues, and exactly-once delivery semantics.
- Served as technical authority in architecture reviews, driving decisions on caching strategy, schema evolution, change-data-capture unification, and service decoupling; delivered proof-of-concepts that secured client approval for the platform initiative.
- Guided a Microsoft Entra ID migration and automated credential rotation across Confluent Cloud and enterprise messaging systems with zero downtime.

Recognition: 2× Connection Award and 1× Transformer Award, all received within first year.

Senior Full Stack Developer | IBM (client: AT&T)

Jun 2021 – Aug 2025

- Built enterprise microservices from scratch with Redis caching, asynchronous processing, and real-time alerting dashboards — cut API response time from ~800ms to ~100ms for high-volume consumer traffic.
- Led modernization of a 15-year legacy monolith — migrated CORBA service interfaces to REST APIs and re-platformed Struts-based UI applications into Spring Boot microservices with OAuth2/OIDC/Entra authentication, now serving 10+ downstream systems at 99.9% uptime.
- Directed end-to-end billing and order management, owning backend services for order creation, generation, validation, and fulfillment across high-throughput enterprise traffic.
- Built Kafka and IBM MQ event-driven pipelines to decouple tightly-coupled legacy systems into fault-tolerant, asynchronous services with retry mechanisms and circuit-breaker patterns.
- Managed migration of a legacy messaging platform (DMAAP) to Kafka and the internal enterprise messaging bus, re-architecting the streaming layer with zero message loss across all dependent systems.
- Drove bug bounty and security remediation efforts — identified and fixed SQL injection, authentication bypass, cross-site scripting (XSS), and insecure deserialization vulnerabilities; implemented OAuth2/OIDC security patterns across enterprise services.
- Designed secure REST APIs with OAuth2/OIDC/Entra authentication, optimized database queries and connection pooling, and validated Spring Boot services across SIT and UAT environments before managing deployments on Azure, WebLogic, and Tomcat while mentoring junior engineers.

Recognition: H1B visa sponsorship, recognized for exceptional technical contribution and business value.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

B.Tech, Computer Science & Engineering — Vignan Institute of Information & Technology (82%)

2016 – 2020

Microsoft Certified: Azure Fundamentals (AZ-900) | SAFe® 5 Practitioner